- Trace: to find/identify the targets, for instance terrorists, supporters, sympathisers, sleeper-agents, financers;
- Trail: to keep a persistent and focused eye on their activities, hideouts, modus operandi;
- Tackle: arrest, prosecute, punish, negotiate (from position of strength), rehabilitate;
- Transform: mullah–masjid–madrasah, hearts and minds policy.

ROLE OF SECURITY AND INTELLIGENCE AGENCIES

The armed forces of Pakistan have been at the forefront of countering insurgency and terrorism. Its role has been discussed at length elsewhere.

The role of various intelligence and law enforcement organisations is briefly discussed below.

Inter-Services Intelligence (ISI)

The ISI was the most well-equipped and resourceful intelligence agency of Pakistan. It played a significant role in countering terrorism in urban centres of the country. It faced the brunt of the TTP and Al Qaeda terrorists as its offices were attacked at Lahore and Multan, killing a number of officers.

From 2006, the US had been increasingly critical of ISI's role in war against terror as it labelled ISI to be running with hare and hunting with hounds. According to some analysts, behaviour and policies of the Pakistan Army and the Inter-Services Intelligence were the biggest problems for the US in achieving its objectives in South Asia. 'The complex relationship that the army had with terrorist groups was a difficult and critical challenge to our interest' (Admiral Mullen interjected that this was the 'heart of the matter').

Who would know better than the Americans that ISI was at the forefront in handling and guiding the Mujahideen against the Soviet forces. It had a long and deep relationship with the Mujahideen and the religious elements that supported them. It was a very difficult task to extricate itself from this relationship and start taking action against their factions. However, it employed all sorts of tactics to contain these elements.

ISI's intelligence support to the military enabled it to carry out successful intelligence-based operations in North Waziristan during Operation 'Zarb-e-Azb'. It operated in urban centres with admirable